civil war so they refused to agree to any increase in immigration. The Haganah, for their part, did all they could to obstruct the British and to assist illegal immigration.

The Palestinian Arabs continued to oppose the idea of a Jewish state in Palestine. They feared that such a state would be filled by immigrants from Nazi Europe who would demand further expansion and a larger Jewish state incorporating all of Palestine. Besides, the Arabs felt that the West should take responsibility for the victims of the Holocaust. After all, the Holocaust had been carried out in the West. The Arabs felt that the Western powers should find a home for the Jews in another part of the world.

Bombing of British military headquarters in Jerusalem 1946

Jewish attacks on British forces now increased, sometimes in retaliation for death sentences passed on Jewish terrorists. In April 1946, six British soldiers were murdered in one incident and, in July 1946, the Irgun carried out their most spectacular act of terrorism – the attack on the King David Hotel in Jerusalem. This hotel housed the British military headquarters in Palestine. It was protected by barbed wire, machine guns and patrolling soldiers. At noon on 22 July 1946, a lorry drove up to the entrance of the hotel kitchen. Men dressed as Arabs got out and unloaded their cargo of milk churns. They rolled them into the building. No one guessed that the milk churns contained high explosives or that the 'Arabs' were members of Irgun. At 12.37pm the explosion tore through the building killing 88 people, including 15 Jews.

Key dates

Attack on the King David Hotel in Jerusalem: 1946

Hanging of two British soldiers by Irgun: 1947

The Exodus prevented from landing in Palestine: 1947

Other terrorist acts

Terrorist incidents like these weakened the morale of the British, both in Palestine and at home. They also led to frustration and anger at what the British saw as support for terrorism from American Zionists. After the killing of 20 British soldiers in the officers' club in Jerusalem in February 1947, the British Prime Minister complained of a report he had heard that the Mayor of New York had launched a Zionist drive to raise £2 million for the purchase of 'men, guns and money'. The British leader protested that:

> the guns which are being subscribed for in America can only be required to shoot at British soldiers in Palestine.

In the summer of 1947 two incidents finally convinced the British that they should withdraw from Palestine. One was the hanging of two British soldiers in revenge for the execution of three Irgun members: a photograph of the two men hanging from a tree appeared on the front page of several British newspapers. The other incident involved a ship called *The Exodus* which was carrying 4500 refugees from Europe. It was prevented, by the British authorities, from landing its passengers in Palestine and was sent back to Europe. This incident attracted widespread